

SCROLLY DIAGNOSTIC SERIES

THE ORGANIC TRAFFIC OPPORTUNITY SCORECARD

Is your website leaving search traffic on the table?

10 categories | 30–40 minutes | Self-assessment

ScrollySEO

A companion diagnostic to the SEO Site Audit

FRONT MATTER

Welcome

The Organic Traffic Opportunity Scorecard

Is your website leaving search traffic on the table?

Most business owners have a rough sense of whether their website is "doing okay" in search, but rarely a structured way to check it. This scorecard gives you one: 10 categories covering the areas most likely to affect whether your business shows up in search, each with specific, plain-English questions you can answer by looking at your own site and your own search results.

By the end, you'll have a clearer picture of where your foundation is solid and where it likely has real gaps, plus a few things worth fixing today. You'll also see, category by category, exactly what a self-assessment like this can and can't tell you, which is genuinely useful to know before deciding how much further to dig.

Expect this to take 30–40 minutes.

What You'll Need

- [ ] Your website open in a browser (and on your phone, if possible)
- [ ] A private/incognito browser window for the search checks
- [ ] Google Search Console and GA4, if you have them (works without either)
- [ ] About 30–40 minutes

How Scoring Works

Each category below has 3 questions (Local Search has 3 and is optional, skip it if you don't serve a specific geographic area). Score each **0 (not really), 1 (partially/not sure), or 2 (yes, clearly)**.

A note on what this score measures. This is a framework for prioritizing where to look closer, not a technical grade, a ranking prediction, or a substitute for real data. A business could score well here and still have real, invisible problems, which is exactly what the "Can't Determine Yourself" sections throughout are for. Treat your lowest-scoring categories as your starting point, not your final answer.

1 Search Visibility

CATEGORY 1 OF 10

WHY THIS MATTERS

If you don't show up when people search for what you offer, nothing else about your website matters yet.

A reminder before you start: your own search results are shaped by your location, device, and search history, so treat what follows as a useful personal snapshot, not a neutral or complete read on how you rank for everyone.

Score This	0–2 per question
1.1. Search Google for the specific products or services you offer, plus your city or core descriptor, not just your business name. Do you appear naturally on page 1, rather than only after scrolling past several competitors, or not appearing at all?	0 1 2
1.2. Try 3–5 different phrases a real customer might use, not just the first one you'd guess. Does your visibility hold up across variations, or do you only appear for one specific phrasing?	0 1 2
1.3. If you're a local business, search your core service plus "near me," or your city, from a phone in a private browsing window. Do you appear in the map pack, rather than only in the regular results below it, or not at all?	0 1 2

0 Not really 1 Partially 2 Yes, clearly

Category total ___ / 6

WHAT YOU CAN'T DETERMINE YOURSELF

VISIBLE TO YOU

You can see whether you personally find your business in a search.

REQUIRES DATA / ANALYSIS

How you rank for people in other locations, devices, or search histories, since personalization affects what everyone sees. Real rank tracking checks from a neutral vantage point across many queries at once, part of what a real audit runs for you.

2 Search Demand & Customer Discovery

WHY THIS MATTERS

Optimizing for the wrong phrase, one that sounds right but that almost nobody actually searches, wastes effort no matter how well everything else is executed.

Score This	0–2 per question
2.1. Could you list, with real confidence, the actual phrases your last several customers likely typed into Google before finding you? If you're not sure, have you ever checked real data (Search Console, customer conversations, reviews) to find out?	0 1 2
2.2. Do you know which of your products or services actually get searched for the most, based on real data rather than assuming based on what you personally consider your best offering?	0 1 2
2.3. Has a search term ever surprised you, in your own analytics, in a review, in a customer question, meaning you learned people search for something you hadn't expected?	0 1 2

0 Not really 1 Partially 2 Yes, clearly

Category total ___ / 6

WHAT YOU CAN'T DETERMINE YOURSELF

VISIBLE TO YOU

You can see whether you've ever thought carefully about customer search language.

→

REQUIRES DATA / ANALYSIS

How many people actually search a given phrase, or how demand splits across variations, since that requires keyword research tools most business owners don't have access to. Without it, it's easy to build a strategy around a phrase that barely gets searched.

3 Website & Structure

WHY THIS MATTERS

A search engine, and a customer, both need to be able to quickly locate the right page for what they're looking for. If your site's structure doesn't reflect how customers think about your offerings, both will struggle.

Score This	0–2 per question
3.1. Show your homepage to someone unfamiliar with your business for 5 seconds, then hide it. Can they tell you what you sell, who it's for, and what to do next? If you can't test this on someone else, be honest about whether a stranger really could.	0 1 2
3.2. Does every core product or service you offer have its own dedicated page, rather than being only mentioned in passing on a general page?	0 1 2
3.3. Starting from your homepage, can a customer reach your most important page within 2–3 clicks, rather than it taking more clicks than most people would realistically follow?	0 1 2

0 Not really 1 Partially 2 Yes, clearly

Category total ___ / 6

WHAT YOU CAN'T DETERMINE YOURSELF

VISIBLE TO YOU

You can see whether your current pages are easy to find.

REQUIRES DATA / ANALYSIS

Whether your structure captures the *full* range of related searches your customers use, not just the ones you've personally thought of, since that requires mapping real search demand against your site's architecture at scale.

4 Content

CATEGORY 4 OF 10

WHY THIS MATTERS

Not every customer search is ready to buy. Content that answers earlier questions captures that demand; a site with none of it hands that demand to whoever does answer it.

Score This	0–2 per question
4.1. List the top 3–5 questions a customer typically asks you before buying, in person, by phone, by email. Does your website actually answer them in writing, rather than that information only existing in your head or in one-off conversations?	0 1 2
4.2. If you publish any articles, guides, or blog content, is there a real, ongoing plan behind it, rather than it having been a burst of activity that's since stopped?	0 1 2
4.3. Does your content connect to a specific commercial page, something you actually sell, rather than existing as general information with no path back to a purchase or inquiry?	0 1 2

0 Not really 1 Partially 2 Yes, clearly

Category total ___ / 6

WHAT YOU CAN'T DETERMINE YOURSELF

VISIBLE TO YOU

You can see what content you've published and whether it connects to a sale.

REQUIRES DATA / ANALYSIS

Whether it covers the topics with real search demand, or how it compares to what's already ranking for those topics, since that requires researching both search volume and existing competing content.

5 On-Page Search Foundations

WHY THIS MATTERS

These are the elements that directly shape how your pages appear in a search result, and whether they're clear enough to earn the click.

Score This	0–2 per question
5.1. Look at how your 3 most important pages would appear in an actual Google result (search your brand plus the page topic, or check your browser tab titles as a rough proxy). Are the titles clear and specific to each page, rather than generic, cut off, or duplicated?	0 1 2
5.2. Do your page URLs make sense to a human (`/services/kitchen-remodeling`), rather than being auto-generated strings of numbers and letters?	0 1 2
5.3. Pick 5 images on your most important pages. Do most of them have real, descriptive alt text (right-click → Inspect to check), rather than being blank or auto-filled?	0 1 2

0 Not really · 1 Partially · 2 Yes, clearly

Category total ___ / 6

WHAT YOU CAN'T DETERMINE YOURSELF

VISIBLE TO YOU

You can confirm whether a title or description exists and reads clearly.

→

REQUIRES DATA / ANALYSIS

Whether it targets a query with meaningful search demand. Presence and optimization are different questions. Answering the second needs the same keyword data referenced in Category 2.

6 Technical Foundations

WHY THIS MATTERS

None of the above matters if a search engine can't properly crawl, load, or index your pages. Most of that is invisible from ordinary browsing.

Score This	0–2 per question
6.1. Load your site on mobile data. Does it feel fast, rather than noticeably lagging, especially on image-heavy pages?	0 1 2
6.2. Does your site load with a padlock (secure connection), not a "not secure" warning, on every page you checked?	0 1 2
6.3. Click through a reasonable sample of links across your site. Did your check turn up no broken links, error pages, or unexpected redirects?	0 1 2

0 Not really · 1 Partially · 2 Yes, clearly

Category total ____ / 6

WHAT YOU CAN'T DETERMINE YOURSELF

VISIBLE TO YOU

You can notice whether your site feels slow or a link is broken.

→

REQUIRES DATA / ANALYSIS

Whether there are crawl errors, indexing issues, redirect chains, or duplicate/conflicting page signals, since most technical SEO problems aren't visible from normal browsing. They require crawling the site the way a search engine does.

7 Local Search (optional)

WHY THIS MATTERS

For a geographically-bound business, local search behaves differently from general organic search, and it's often where the most immediate opportunity sits. Skip this category if you don't serve a specific geographic area.

Score This	0–2 per question
7.1. Is your Google Business Profile fully filled out (category, hours, service area, photos), with no obvious gaps or outdated information?	0 1 2
7.2. Have you responded to your recent reviews, positive or negative, and are new reviews still coming in reasonably regularly?	0 1 2
7.3. Is your business name, address, and phone number listed identically across the places you know you're listed (your website, Google, Facebook, Yelp), rather than having known inconsistencies?	0 1 2

0 Not really 1 Partially 2 Yes, clearly

Category total ___ / 6

WHAT YOU CAN'T DETERMINE YOURSELF

VISIBLE TO YOU

You can see the state of your own listing.

REQUIRES DATA / ANALYSIS

Whether you're actually winning or losing the local map pack against your specific competitors, since that requires checking how you rank against them across many searches and locations.

8 Authority & Trust Signals

WHY THIS MATTERS

Search engines and customers both use outside evidence, not just your own claims, to judge whether a business is credible.

Score This	0–2 per question
8.1. Can you name any real websites, news coverage, industry directories, partner sites, local organizations, that link to your website? If you're not sure, have you ever actually checked?	0 1 2
8.2. Does your site display credible trust signals, real testimonials, case studies, credentials, press mentions, rather than mostly generic claims with no evidence behind them?	0 1 2
8.3. If a customer researched your business beyond your own website, would they find consistent, positive information, rather than very little presence at all?	0 1 2

0 Not really 1 Partially 2 Yes, clearly

Category total ___ / 6

WHAT YOU CAN'T DETERMINE YOURSELF

VISIBLE TO YOU

You can see the trust signals displayed on your own site.

→

REQUIRES DATA / ANALYSIS

The real shape of your backlink profile, how many sites link to you, how authoritative they are, and how that compares to competitors, since most links to your site aren't visible anywhere on your own pages.

9 AI & Emerging Search Discovery

WHY THIS MATTERS

A growing share of search-like behavior now happens through AI assistants instead of a traditional search box. How well those systems can describe your business starts with how clear and consistent your public information already is, which is something you genuinely can check yourself.

Score This	0–2 per question
9.1. Read your homepage as a stranger with no other context. Is it unambiguous what your business does or sells, without requiring the reader to infer or guess?	0 1 2
9.2. Pick 2–3 of your most important products, services, or offerings. Are they described with enough factual detail (what they are, who they're for, key attributes) to be understood correctly out of context?	0 1 2
9.3. Is your core business information (name, what you do, location if relevant) consistent across your website and the major public profiles or listings you maintain (Google Business Profile, major directories, social profiles)?	0 1 2

0 Not really 1 Partially 2 Yes, clearly

Category total ___ / 6

WHAT YOU CAN'T DETERMINE YOURSELF

VISIBLE TO YOU

You can see whether your own information is clear, detailed, and consistent.

REQUIRES DATA / ANALYSIS

How AI systems will actually respond when asked about your business, since that depends on structured testing across multiple platforms and query variations. A single question you ask yourself isn't a reliable signal either way.

10 Measurement

CATEGORY 10 OF 10

WHY THIS MATTERS

Everything above is easier to act on with real data behind it, and impossible to verify over time without it.

Score This	0–2 per question
10.1. Do you have Google Analytics (GA4) and Search Console actually installed and connected right now, and could you log in and check them today?	0 1 2
10.2. If they're installed, have you looked at them in the last 30 days, rather than them existing but going unchecked?	0 1 2
10.3. If a customer told you they "found you on Google," could you confirm that with real data, rather than taking their word for it?	0 1 2

0 Not really 1 Partially 2 Yes, clearly

Category total ____ / 6

WHAT YOU CAN'T DETERMINE YOURSELF

VISIBLE TO YOU

You can see whether measurement tools are installed and whether you check them.

→

REQUIRES DATA / ANALYSIS

Historical visibility or traffic patterns, if measurement wasn't in place previously, for you or for anyone. That gap is itself a finding worth knowing.

YOUR RESULTS

What Your Scorecard Shows

ADD YOUR 9 CORE CATEGORY TOTALS (CATEGORIES 1–6, 8–10; MAX 54). ADD CATEGORY 7 TOO IF LOCAL SEARCH APPLIES (MAX 60).

_____ / 54 Plot your total on the bands below

0–18	**Several Visible Foundation Gaps.** A number of categories point to gaps worth investigating. These may be limiting search visibility, but determining the actual size of the opportunity requires search-demand, competitive, and technical data this self-assessment can't provide.
19–36	**Some Real Foundation, Real Blind Spots.** Parts of your presence show reasonably clear signals; others show gaps worth a closer look. This suggests where to focus, not how much traffic or ranking is actually at stake.
37–54	**Solid Visible Signals, Real Limits to What Self-Assessment Can See.** You're handling the visible parts well. What's genuinely out of view from here, competitor comparisons, real demand data, technical depth, backlinks, is exactly what the "Can't Determine Yourself" sections describe throughout.

Your 2–3 lowest-scoring categories matter more than the total. *They tell you where to focus first, which is more useful than a single number, regardless of where that number lands.*

YOUR RESULTS, CONTINUED

Plot Your Ten Category Scores

Shade each bar to your category total, using the scores from each category's total box. Then circle your 2–3 lowest bars, they matter more than the overall number, and are the best place to start. Category 7 (Local Search) is optional; skip it in your plot if it doesn't apply to your business.

1 · Search Visibility		/ 6
2 · Search Demand		/ 6
3 · Website & Structure		/ 6
4 · Content		/ 6
5 · On-Page Foundations		/ 6
6 · Technical Foundations		/ 6
7 · Local Search (optional)		/ 6
8 · Authority & Trust		/ 6
9 · AI & Emerging Search		/ 6
10 · Measurement		/ 6

NEXT STEPS

What You Can Do Next, On Your Own

A few things worth acting on immediately, regardless of your score:

- If Category 7 or 10 scored low, connect or complete your Google Business Profile, GA4, and Search Console. This costs nothing and closes a real gap.
- If Category 5 scored low, fix the title and description on your single most important page.
- If Category 4 scored low, write down the 3 questions customers ask most before buying, even before you publish anything answering them.
- Respond to your 2–3 most recent reviews if you haven't (Category 7).

These are genuinely useful on their own. None of them require special tools, and none of them reach into the categories where this scorecard was upfront about its own limits.

When the SEO Site Audit Makes Sense

This scorecard can reveal visible signals and blind spots. What it can't do, by design, is tell you how large a gap actually is, what's causing it, how you compare to the specific businesses you're competing with in search, or which of your gaps deserves attention first. Those are exactly the questions a self-assessment structurally can't answer, no matter how carefully you fill it out.

YOU NOW KNOW

- ✓ Where your visible foundation is solid, and where it likely has real gaps
- ✓ A few things you can fix today, at no cost
- ✓ Exactly what a self-assessment can and can't tell you, category by category

THE AUDIT INVESTIGATES

- → A real technical and indexation crawl of your actual site
- → Keyword and demand research at scale
- → A competitor-by-competitor comparison
- → Backlink and authority analysis, local visibility testing, and a prioritized roadmap built from your specific data

The scorecard can reveal visible warning signs and blind spots. The SEO Site Audit investigates the things a self-assessment cannot determine, and turns them into a prioritized, business-specific opportunity analysis.

KEEP THIS HANDY

One-Page Score Summary

Record your category scores here for quick reference.

CATEGORY	SCORE (/6)
1. Search Visibility	___
2. Search Demand & Customer Discovery	___
3. Website & Structure	___
4. Content	___
5. On-Page Search Foundations	___
6. Technical Foundations	___
7. Local Search (if applicable)	___
8. Authority & Trust Signals	___
9. AI & Emerging Search Discovery	___
10. Measurement	___
Total	___

My 3 lowest-scoring categories:

My 1 highest-priority fix I can do myself this week: